Style Guide

2026 HSURV Abstract Book

Please **READ THIS** over before submitting your abstract.

If you have any questions/concerns related to style, please email one of our Editors-in-Chief:

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The following style rules are organized in alphabetical order.

Capitalization

- Multi-word terms for which an acronym is introduced should generally not be capitalized

Citations

- None should be used!

Colons

- Used to emphasize that the second clause illustrates the first (a sense of "as follows")
- If the sentence would work without the colon, it shouldn't have a colon.
- Word after colon should be lowercase, unless it's a proper noun or starts a series of multiple sentences that are part of the illustration

Comprise/Compose

- Comprise means to be made up of (e.g. the whole comprises the parts)
- Compose means to make up (e.g. the parts compose the whole, or the whole is composed of the parts)
- "Comprised of" is *incorrect*

CRISPR-Cas9

- Formatted just like that

Dashes

- DO NOT USE em dashes — so don't use that in a case such as this!
- En dashes (which are shorter than em dashes) should mainly be used to replace the word "to"
    - E.g. Mice A won the game 14–6

Disease Names

- Generally not capitalized, unless it's a disease named after someone (e.g. Down syndrome, non-Hodgkin lymphoma)
- Should not take possessive form (e.g. Crohn disease, not Crohn's disease)
- Adjectival or derivative forms of proper names are not capitalized in disease names (e.g. parkinsonism)

Genes & Proteins

- Human and other mammal genes are all-caps and italicized (e.g. *BRCA1*)
- Mouse genes are usually italicized with first letter in caps (e.g. *Cmv1*)
- Proteins are not italicized

Hyphens

- Used for an adjectival compound before a noun (e.g. well-read man)

Indents

- None should be used!

Italics

- Italicize Latin species names
- Italicize phrases from non-English languages
- Italicize titles of books, works of art
- Italicize *in vivo, in vitro, in situ*
    - Even if part of a well-known technique (e.g. *in situ* hybridization)
- Do not italicize common Latin abbreviations (ex. et al., e.g., i.e.)

- Italics may be used *sparingly* for emphasis or to set off certain words that are being defined, at the author's discretion

Numbers

- Numbers one through ten should be written out
- Any decimal should be a PERIOD, not a comma
- Any percentage should be numerical (85%)
- Numbers used in a **quantitative sense** can be expressed with **numerals** (e.g. this experiment took place over 30 days, the U.S. spends $2 billion each year)
- Numbers used to **illustrate concepts in a qualitative sense** should be **spelled out** (e.g. over thirty years ago, I was not yet born)

Paragraph Breaks

- Just press "enter" between sentences to denote start of new paragraph

Parentheses

- If something italicized like a species name is inside the parentheses, the parentheses should still be non-italic (e.g. I am a human (*Homo sapiens*))
- Period goes inside parentheses if the parenthetical is its own complete sentence (In this parenthetical, the period would go inside.)
- Period goes outside parentheses if the parenthetical is part of another sentence (like this).

Possessive

SINGULAR

- The possessive of most singular nouns is formed by adding an apostrophe and an s (e.g. the horse's mouth, a bass's stripes)
- The general rule extends to proper nouns, including names ending in s, x, or z, in both their singular and plural forms, as well as letters and numbers (e.g. Marx's theories, Berlioz's works)
- When the singular form of a noun ending in s is the same as the plural (i.e. the plural is uninflected), the possessives of both are formed by the addition of an apostrophe only (e.g. politics' true meaning, economics' forerunners)
- The same rule applies when the name of a place or an organization or a publication (or the last element in the name) is a plural form ending in s, such as the United States, even though the entity is singular (e.g. the United States' role in international law, Highland Hills' late mayor)

PLURAL

- The possessive of plural nouns — except for a few irregular plurals, like children, that do not end in s — is formed by adding an apostrophe only (e.g. puppies' paws, children's literature)

Quotation Marks & Punctuation

- Double, not single, quotation marks
- Periods and commas go inside quotation marks
- Colons and semicolons go outside quotation marks

Restriction Enzymes

- First three letters italicized (e.g. *Bam*HI, *Hin*dIII)

Semicolons

- Used only for independent clauses (complete sentences), to indicate that two clauses or sentences are closely related
- Can also be used in lists if the items in the list themselves contain commas or are very complex

Serial Comma (the Oxford Comma)

- Use it when appropriate (e.g. red, white, and blue)

Slashes

- None should be used!

Space After Periods

- One space, not two

Spelling

- Use standard American spellings, not British (e.g. color, standardization, meter, etc.)

Titles

- The conventions of headline style are governed mainly by emphasis and grammar. The following rules, though occasionally arbitrary, are intended primarily to facilitate the consistent styling of titles mentioned or cited in text and notes:
    1. Capitalize the first and last words in titles and subtitles (but see rule 7), and capitalize all other major words (e.g. nouns, pronouns, verbs, adjectives, adverbs, and some conjunctions—but see rule 4)
    2. Lowercase the articles the, a, and an
    3. Lowercase prepositions, regardless of length, except when they are used adverbially or adjectivally, or when they compose part of a Latin expression used adjectivally or adverbially (e.g. De Facto, In Vitro, etc.)
    4. Lowercase the conjunctions and, but, for, or, and nor
    5. Lowercase “to” not only as a preposition (rule 3) but also as part of an infinitive, and lowercase as in any grammatical function
    6. Lowercase the part of a proper name that would be lowercase in text, such as de or von
    7. Lowercase the second part of a species name, such as *fulvescens* in *Acipenser fulvescens*, even if it is the last word in a title or subtitle

Which vs. That

- **That:** used when the clause is an **essential** part of the subject
    - E.g. Our office that has two lunchrooms is located in Cincinnati
        - Implies that we have other offices with different numbers of lunchrooms; we need the phrase “that has two lunchrooms” to distinguish which one we are talking about
- **Which:** used when the clause is a **non-essential** part of the subject
    - E.g. Our office, which has two lunchrooms, is located in Cincinnati
        - “Which has two lunchrooms” is just a side note here. The sentence would still be clear without it

Wild Type

- Hyphenated if used as adjective before a noun, which is probably most of the time (the wild-type flies)
- Not hyphenated if used as a noun itself (comparing the wild type to the mutant)
- **Not one word**